What the IB discovered was that Abdullah was a part of a National Conference working committee, set up as part of the constituent assembly, along with other leading figures in his administration. They all sought radical solutions to the Indo-Pakistani dispute over Kashmir, which was now entering its sixth year. The committee had before it a wide range of possibilities including the accession of the state of Jammu and Kashmir to Pakistan and the establishment of its total independence. In addition, it was examining a variety of plebiscitary devices such as the wily compromises thought up by Sir Owen Dixon in 1950, which were all previously rejected by Abdullah. The working committee, however, came to no conclusions. Nevertheless, its very existence was extremely alarming to Nehru.

Karan Singh Comes of Age

A concerned Sadr-e-Riyasat, Dr Karan Singh, flew down to New Delhi in the third week of July 1953 to see Nehru. Nehru was a changed man with respect to his outlook towards Abdullah. He was ready and willing to take the bull by its horns before it caused any irreparable damage. There was a pronounced rift in Abdullah's cabinet on 7 August 1953; Abdullah was left with only Beg's support. Abdullah forced a showdown by asking Pandit Ram Lal Saraf, leader of the dissenters to resign. Saraf refused to resign and angered Abdullah even further by firing off an accusatory letter accusing Abdullah of treason. This was followed by a memorandum sent to Abdullah on 8 August 1953 by other cabinet dissenters—Bakshi Ghulam Mohammed, G. L. Dogra and Pandit Ram Lal Saraf. A copy of this memorandum was marked to Dr Karan Singh. Abdullah decided to go to Gulmarg later that day and dropped in to speak to Dr Karan Singh. During the meeting, he declared his intention to seek external help to pressurise the Indian Government to grant the state of Jammu and Kashmir independence.[30]

After Abdullah's departure, a distraught and worried Karan Singh called in D. P. Dhar and Brig. B. M. Kaul, who was the state's military advisor. They came to the conclusion that Abdullah had to be dismissed. Bakshi